

THOMAS KABALIN

thomaskabalin.com | linkedin.com/in/thomaskabalin | github.com/tkabalin

PROFILE

Third-year Bachelor of Business Science student at UCT, specialising in Computer Science, with a strong academic record and demonstrated leadership skills. Recipient of the Vice-Chancellor's Scholarship, BSG Award for top second-year Computer Science student, and multiple class medals. Proficient in Java, Python, PHP (Laravel), and C#, with practical experience as a backend engineer at a fintech company. Motivated by the intersection of technology and business, with interests spanning software development, AI, data science, and quantitative finance.

EDUCATION

- 2024 – Present **Bachelor of Business Science specialising in Computer Science, University of Cape Town**
- Received the Vice Chancellor's scholarship for being among the top 10 applicants to UCT from the Western Cape in 2024.
- GPA:** 88.13 (1st Year) · 85.68 (2nd Year)
- Awards:** Bain & Company Award (3rd Place, First-Year BBusSci) · BSG Prize (Best 2nd-Year CS Student) · Class Awards: CSC1016S, CSC2002S, STA2020F · Dean's Merit List (2024, 2025)
- 2018 – 2023 **National Senior Certificate (Matric), Cannons Creek High School**
- Aggregate:** 96.3%
- School Awards:** Dux Scholar · Principal's Honour Award · 8 Distinctions (90%+) · 99% in three subjects · Top marks in the school across all eight subjects
- External Awards:** 2nd Place, National Applications Olympiad · Excellent Academic Achievement, NSC Exams (Top 40 in Western Cape)

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Jan 2026 – Present **Junior Software Developer, Fynbos Technologies**
- Working as a backend engineer building features for a PHP and Laravel based fintech platform, contributing to a product with tangible impact on personal finance and investment in South Africa.
- Jan 2021 – Present **Entrepreneur, Digital Study Materials Business**
- Operated a small business marketing and selling digital study notes to high school and university students, both through online platforms and directly within my courses. The venture generated R16 000 in profit in 2024, developing practical skills in sales, marketing, and independent business management.
- Jan 2025 & 2026 **Data Entry, IT and Administrative Assistant (Seasonal), Cannons Creek Independent School**
- Provided support to the executive head of the school, IT integrator and high school secretary ahead of the new school year. Key tasks included managing digital calendars, updating student data on EdAdmin and CEMIS, and creating, removing and resetting user profiles on Windows Server.

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

Languages: Java, Python, C#, PHP (Laravel), SQL – with working knowledge of HTML, CSS, R, and Delphi.

Tools & Environments: JetBrains IDEs, VS Code, Git, GitHub, Linux (Ubuntu, Arch), WSL.

Data Analysis: Python, R, and Excel for data manipulation and visualisation.

Generative AI: Extensive experience integrating generative AI tools across academic, personal, and professional contexts. Familiar with AI-assisted software development workflows and the practical application of large language models to accelerate problem-solving and productivity.

Analytical & Problem-Solving Skills: Demonstrated through consistent high academic performance in quantitative disciplines, including Computer Science, Statistics, and Mathematics, as well as through practical software development and independent business experience.

Business & Entrepreneurship: Practical experience in sales, marketing, and independent business operations.

LEADERSHIP AND EXTRA-CURRICULAR

- **External Moderator**, South African Applications Olympiad (2026 – Present)
- **Scientific Committee Member**, South African Programming Olympiad (2024 – Present)
- **Member**, UCT Underwater Club (2025 – Present)
- **Member**, UCT Mountain and Ski Club (2025 – Present)
- **Prefect**, Cannons Creek High School (2023)
- **Head**, Sound, Lighting and AV Team (2021 – 2022)
- **Chairperson**, Photographic Society (2021 – 2022)
- **Treasurer**, Matric Dance Committee (2022)
- **Head**, Pupil Marketing Team (2020 – 2021)

CAREER EXPLORATION AND DEVELOPMENT

Dec 2025	Data Science Job Shadow, Prescient Investment Management Gained exposure to Prescient’s culture, investment philosophy, and data-driven investment approach. Shadowed teams across Quantitative Analysis, Data Science, and Sales to better understand the way technology is used throughout the business. Built and evaluated a machine learning model estimating U.S. recession probabilities using the Treasury yield curve, providing hands-on insight into methods used in systematic investing.
Apr 2023	Young Executives Programme, Deloitte Participated in Deloitte's Young Executives Programme, gaining exposure to the firm's culture and professional environment.
Sept 2022	CTO and IT Team Job Shadow, Habari Media Spent two days shadowing the CTO and several members of the technology team, gaining exposure to SEO optimisation, frontend development, and backend development. This experience gave me insight into career paths within the IT industry.

CERTIFICATIONS AND ONLINE COURSES

Machine Learning (Google) · Data Science (Cambridge International Qualifications) · Python & Algorithmic Trading (freeCodeCamp, LinkedIn Learning)

HOBBIES

Multi-Day Backpacking · SCUBA Diving · Trail Running · Photography